On the day

Thanksgiving service · Sunday 6 December 2026
A simple guide for whoever is running the screen

WHAT TO PLAY

- The film — “01 - Film for the big screen (HD).mp4”. Length 5 minutes 53 seconds, sound included.
- Play it from a USB stick or laptop, not from the internet. Church Wi-Fi is never reliable on the day.
- Keep the phone version (“02 - Film for phones.mp4”) on a second device as a backup.

THE WEEK BEFORE (AROUND 1 DECEMBER)

- Play the film once on the actual projector and sound system.
- Check the sound comes through the PA, not just the laptop speakers.
- Stand at the back: can you read the lyrics on screen? If not, move the screen or dim the lights.
- Set the laptop to never sleep and turn off notifications.

RUNNING ORDER (SUGGESTION)

- Before the service: show the tribute wall on a second screen if the venue allows — guests love seeing their messages.
- The moment: introduce it in one line — “Brother Sam, this is from all of us.” — then press play, full screen.
- The film ends with a short tribute to Ayoola and Femi, then Sam in his own words, then the birthday card. Let it play to the very end.
- Invite everyone to sing the chorus. Lyric sheets are in this pack (“05 - Song lyrics with meanings.pdf”).

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Film freezes: close it and play the backup file. Nobody will mind a 30-second pause.
- No sound: play from a phone held to the microphone, or connect a phone to the PA with an aux cable.

ONE SMALL FAVOUR

- Please ask someone to film the room (not the screen) while it plays — Sam’s face, the family, the singing. It is the best keepsake of all.